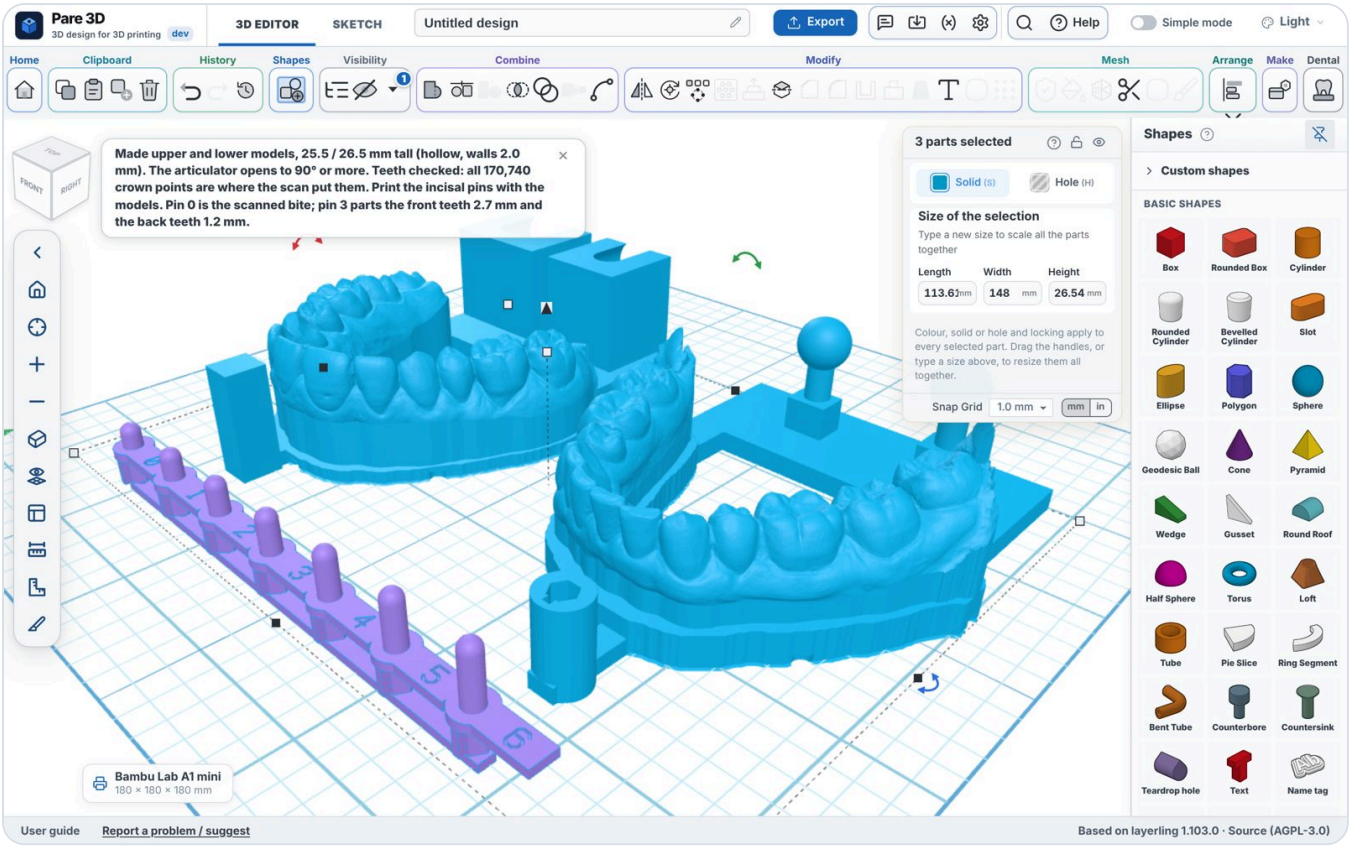
Pare 3D · Dental Studio · Build 78 · October 2026

The Model Builder Guide

From intraoral scans to printed study, ortho, aligner, crown-and-bridge and articulated models - six steps, every setting explained for clinicians.



An upper and lower pair made from three intraoral scan files, with the kinematic articulator behind the molars, the incisal pin socket in front and the pin set, laid out ready to print.

Screens shown are from Pare 3D build 78 on a 1440 × 900 window. Scans used: a full upper arch (330,577 triangles), a full lower arch and a buccal bite scan from the author's own mouth.

Contents

1 What Dental Studio does
2 Before you start: scans and files
3 Opening Dental Studio
4 Step 1 - Add the scans
5 The bite: kept as the scanner exported it
6 Step 2 - Prepare the scans: trim and fill, then check the teeth
7 Step 3 - Choose the model
8 Step 4 - The base and the model's height
9 Step 5 - The articulator
10 Step 6 - Name the model
11 Making the models
12 Editing a scan by hand: Sculpt
13 Printing
14 Messages and what to do
15 Quick reference
16 Accuracy, and checking a printed articulator
17 References

The short way

Home page › **Dental models from scans** › drag the upper, lower and bite files onto the window › pick what the model is for › tick **Print as an articulator** if you want one › **Make models** › **Send to** your slicer. Everything else in this guide is for when you want to change what Pare 3D chose.

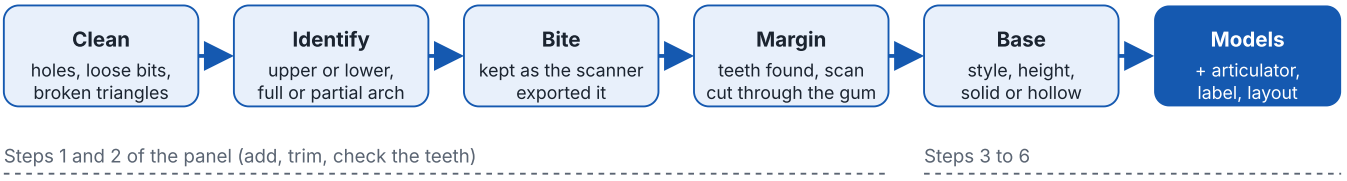
New in build 78

One articulator, built so it cannot change the scanned bite: a kinematic seat on two ball condyles and the incisal pin, held on by keepers - no bands or clips (chapter 9). Printed incisal pins, 0 to 6 mm, swap in to open the bite. The scanner's bite is kept exactly as exported (chapter 5). Every model's teeth are checked against the scan, and soft tissue behind the last teeth that would hold the models open is trimmed; gum that teeth meet never is. A new chapter covers accuracy and how to check a printed articulator (chapter 16).

1 What Dental Studio does

Dental Studio turns raw intraoral scans - open surfaces that end where the scanner stopped - into closed, printable models with a base, and, for a pair, matching bases in the bite and an optional articulator.

It does the work a dental lab technician or a model-builder program (Medit Model Builder, 3Shape Model Builder) does, in one panel and in this order:



The first four happen by themselves as soon as the scans are in; you check them and change what you want.

What is never changed

- **The tooth surface.** The scanned teeth and the gum beside them are kept exactly as scanned. They are only turned and moved as a whole; no point of the kept surface moves relative to another. Trimming and margin cuts never cross a tooth.
- **The bite.** Arches that arrive in occlusion stay exactly where the scanner put them: the jaw relationship is the one your scanning software recorded. Only if you ask is each arch fitted to the bite scan, by one rigid transform each - and then that fit is locked in (chapter 5).
- **Checked, every time.** Every crown point of each scan is checked against the finished model before it is handed over, and the notice says so (chapter 16).

What you get

- One model per arch, closed and printable, named after the scan (*<scan name> upper model*, *<scan name> lower model*), with a base of the kind you chose.
- For a pair: matching bases that stand in the bite, laid out side by side on the build plate or stacked in occlusion, and - if you ask - an articulator built into the bases.
- A notice saying what was made (heights, hollow or solid, wall thickness) and any warnings.

> **Where it runs**
> Everything happens on your own computer, in the Pare 3D app or browser tab; scans are never uploaded. An articulated pair from full-arch scans took about 50 s on a small 2-core test machine; a recent desktop is faster. The window stays responsive while it works.

2 Before you start: scans and files

Dental Studio needs the arch scans as surface meshes, in millimetres, exported from the same case so they share the scanner's coordinates.

File types

Format	Use	Notes
STL	Most common export from all scanners	Geometry only. Pare 3D reads binary and text STL.
PLY	Medit, 3Shape and others export colour this way	Read as geometry; scan colour is not used for the model.
OBJ	Some scanners and labs	Geometry is used; textures are ignored.
3MF	Exported from other programs	Each mesh in it comes in as a part.

What to export from the scanner

1. **Upper arch** - the maxillary scan.
2. **Lower arch** - the mandibular scan.
3. **Bite scan** (optional but recommended for a pair) - the buccal bite registration: the scan of the teeth in occlusion from the buccal side. Most scanners export it as a third file, or include it in the case export.

> **Export all three from the same case, without moving them**
> Scanners export the arches and the bite in one shared coordinate system, usually already in occlusion. Dental Studio starts from those positions. A scan that was moved, mirrored or re-oriented in another program before export may not line up; Pare 3D then says so (*The two scans are not where the scanner put them...*) and makes each arch on its own.

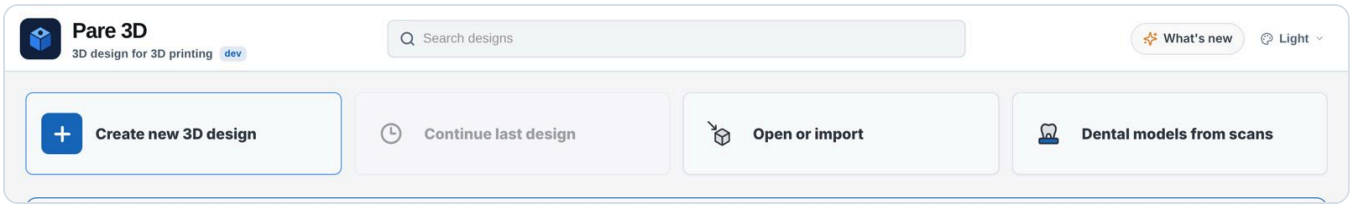
Scan quality that matters

- **Captured depth.** Scan far enough into the vestibule and lingual sulcus for the base you want. The panel reports how many millimetres of scan lie below the occlusal plane for each arch; an ortho base needs the most.
- **Holes and loose islands.** Small holes are filled and loose fragments are removed automatically. Large gaps on the teeth themselves cannot be invented - rescan those areas.
- **Partial arches** (a quadrant or sextant) are recognised as partial and get a block base; the tie bar option is for full arches only (chapter 4, *Full arch or quadrant*).
- **Units.** Files must be in millimetres. A scan that comes in a few millimetres or several metres across was exported in another unit.

> **Patient files**
> Name files with a patient code rather than the patient's name if the designs or exports will be shared. The Label option (chapter 10) engraves a code on the model.

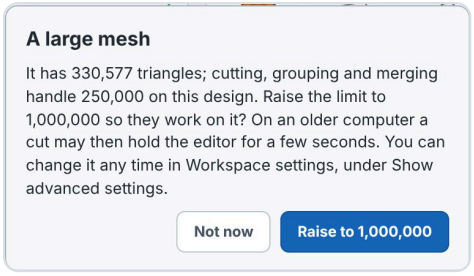
3 Opening Dental Studio

There are three ways in; all end in the same panel.



The home page. **Dental models from scans** opens a new design with Dental Studio already open; **What's new** lists what each build brought.

1. **From the home page** - click **Dental models from scans**. A new, empty design opens with Dental Studio ready (fastest for a new case).
2. **By dropping the files** - drag the scan files from your desktop or a folder onto the editor window. A dashed frame shows while you hold them over it; they come in when you let go. Pare 3D recognises intraoral scans and offers **Dental Studio** in a notice at the bottom of the window.
3. **From the toolbar** - the tooth button in the **Dental** group, or search `Ctrl` + `K` for *dental*, *articulator* or *model builder*. With scans selected, those are used; with none selected, every scan in the design is offered.

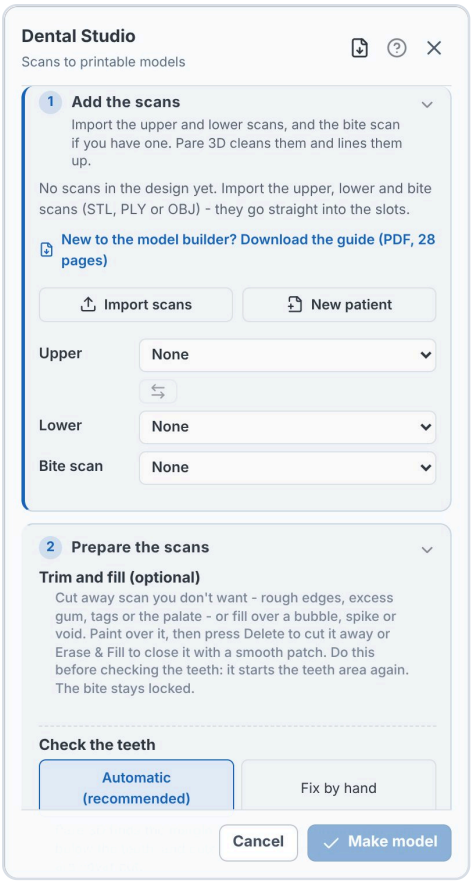


Offered once a session when a scan has more triangles than cutting and grouping handle.

A large mesh: raise the limit once

Cutting, grouping and merging an imported mesh are worked out in the browser, up to a limit of 250,000 triangles by default. A full-arch scan has more (330,577 for the upper used here). When one comes in, a card offers to raise the limit for the design to room for twice the mesh - at least 1,000,000. Press **Raise to 1,000,000**: Dental Studio itself does not need it, but grouping a model with a label or cutting it with a hole does. On an older computer a cut can then hold the editor for a few seconds.

The card asks once a session. The setting stays in **Workspace settings** under **Show advanced settings** (*Cut imported meshes up to*), to change at any time.



Dental Studio before any scan is in.

The panel: six step cards

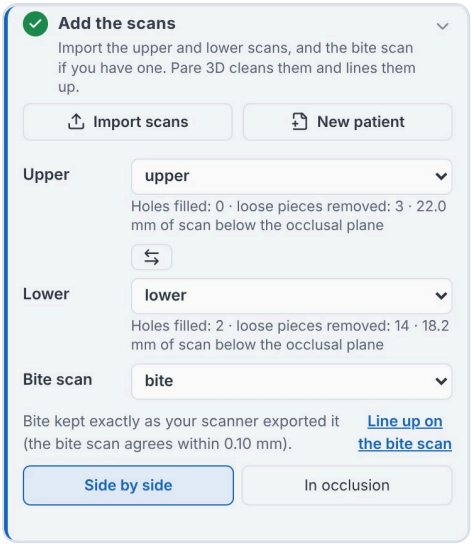
Each step sits on a card of its own, top to bottom. A step's number turns into a green tick once it is complete and you have worked in it. Once the scans are in, the step to do next is outlined in green until you have worked in it. Click a step's title to fold it to one line that sums up its settings, and again to open it; the card you last worked in is marked with a blue edge. The line above the buttons says what is still needed - for example *All set - press Make models*.

1. **Add the scans** - which scan is upper, lower and bite; side by side or in occlusion.
2. **Prepare the scans** - trim or fill what you do not want, then check the teeth.
3. **Choose the model** - what it is for, and solid or hollow.
4. **Base** - its shape, details and the model's height.
5. **Articulator** - only shown for a pair.
6. **Name the model** - a label, or no patient details.

With a single arch the articulator card is left out, so there are five. The panel can be dragged by its title bar; the download button beside **?** saves this guide as a PDF (also linked in step 1 before any scan is in); **?** opens this part of the user guide; **×** or **Cancel** closes it without changing anything.

4 Step 1 - Add the scans

Bring the files in, check that each landed in the right slot, and read the cleaning report under each arch.



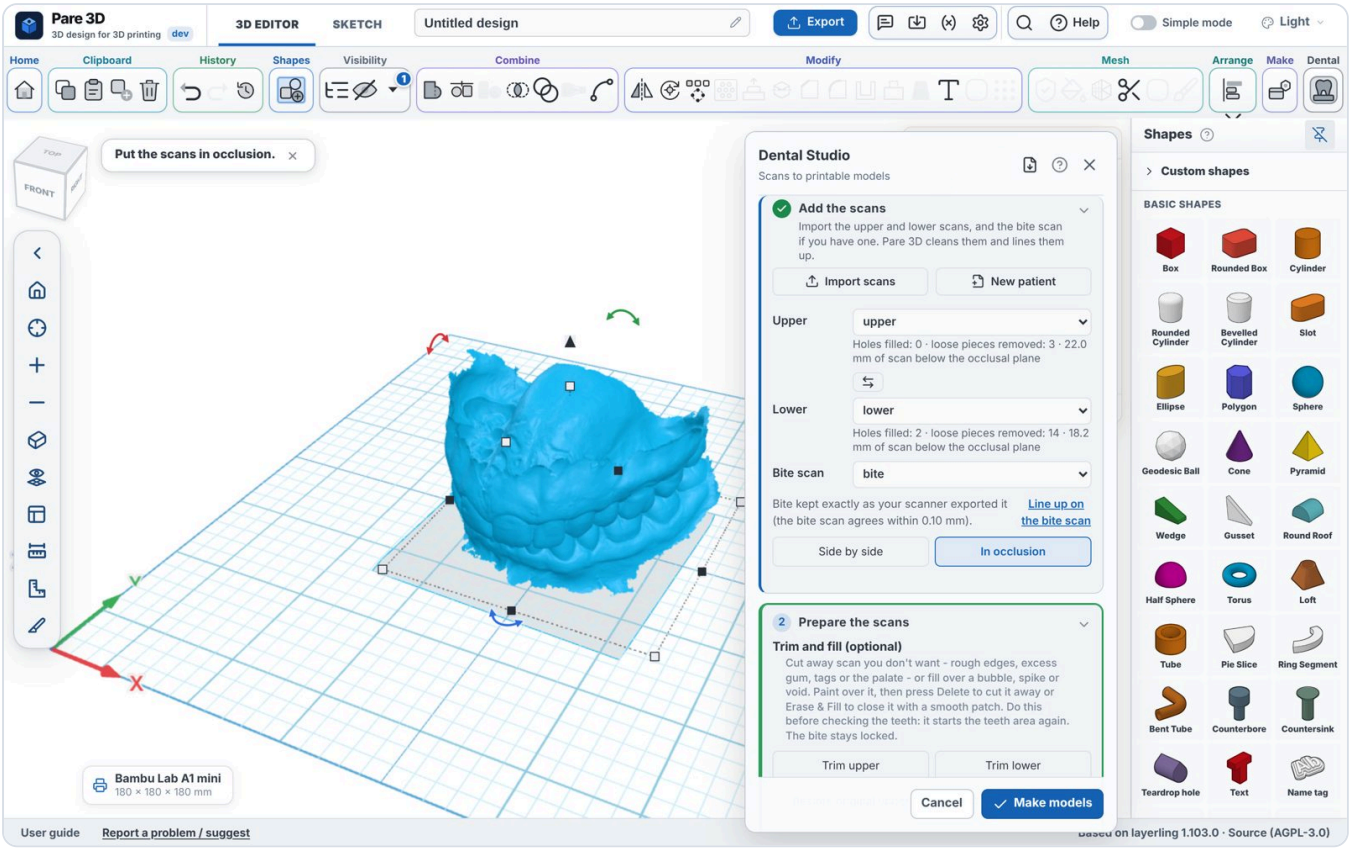
All three slots filled; the bite is locked in.

1. Drag the upper, lower and bite files onto the window together, or click **Import scans** and choose them together. They go straight into the slots.
2. Check the **Upper**, **Lower** and **Bite scan** menus. Each lists every scan in the design and *None*.
3. If upper and lower came out the wrong way round, click the swap button (⇅) between them.
4. Read the line under the slots: *Bite locked in from the bite scan…*, *Upper and lower are in occlusion*, or a warning (chapter 14).

One arch is enough for a single model: leave the other slot on *None*. **New patient** starts a new design with Dental Studio open, so the next patient's scans cannot mix with these.

Side by side, or in occlusion

Once the bite is found, the scans are laid out **side by side** on the plate - the upper on the left, the lower on the right, each teeth up with its front towards you - and the bite scan is hidden. **In occlusion** puts the pair in the bite to check it; **Side by side** puts them back for trimming. Neither changes the scans.



In occlusion: the two scans in the locked bite, to check it from the front and sides.

How Pare 3D tells the upper from the lower

When you have not chosen the slots yourself, each scan is scored on three cues, strongest first: **which way the teeth point** (scanners place the upper above the lower, so its teeth point down - read on the file's vertical, whether the scanner exported it Z-up or Y-up), **a scanned palate**, and **the width across the canines**. For a pair in occlusion the choice is then checked by the overjet: the upper incisors must stand in front of the lower. Your own choice in the menus always wins.

Full arch or quadrant

A full arch is a U: its middle is the tongue or palate, with no tooth there. A quadrant or sextant has its teeth at its middle. Pare 3D counts an arch as a quadrant only when at least 2% of its tooth surface lies within 3 mm of the middle of the teeth - a single scrap (a tag of tongue, or what a trim left) is not enough. Before build 75 one point was; on some scans that made every base come out as a quadrant's rectangular block.

The cleaning report

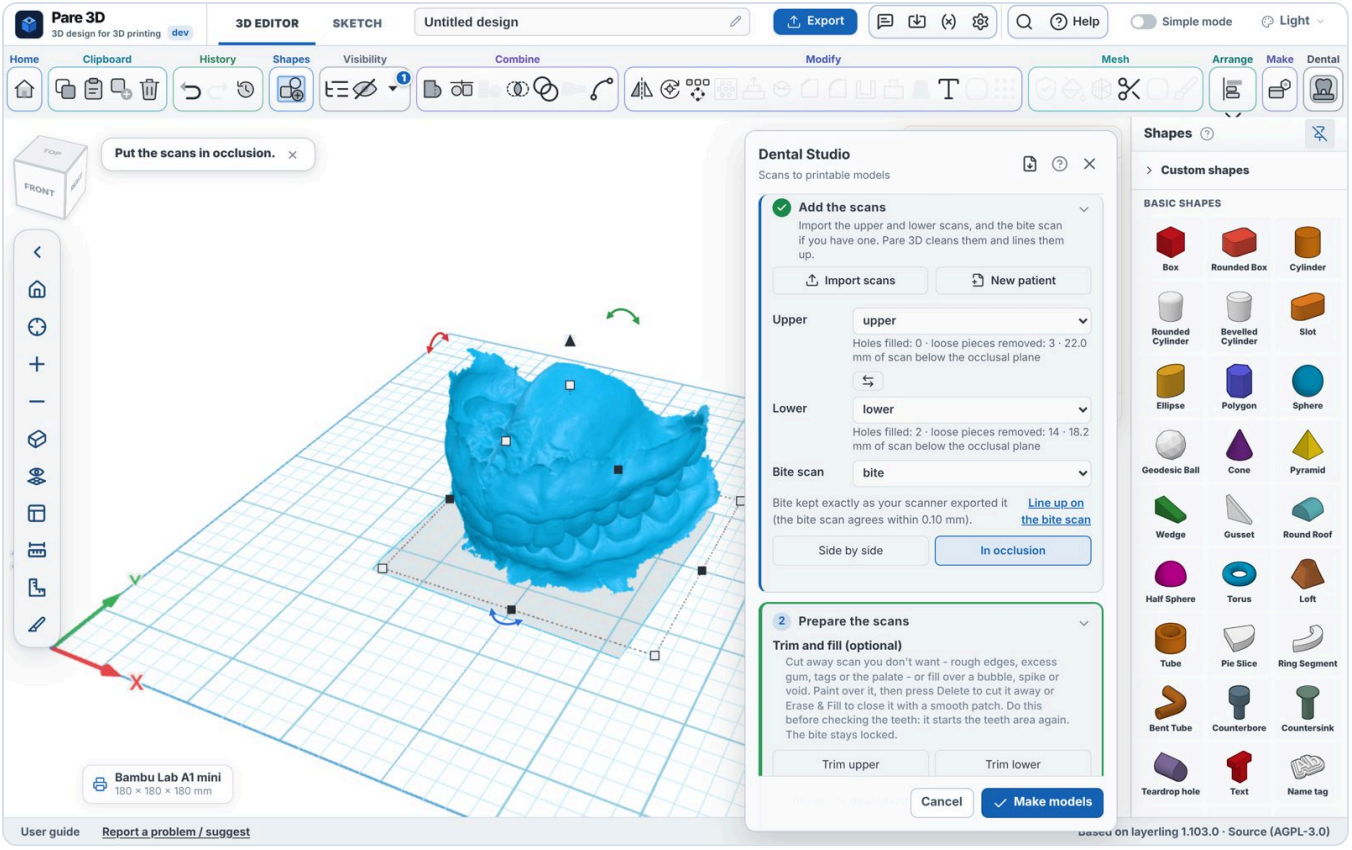
Each arch is cleaned the moment it is chosen. The line under it reads, for example, *Holes filled: 2 · loose pieces removed: 14 · 18.5 mm of scan below the occlusal plane*.

Item	What was done
Holes filled	Every opening in the surface except the scan's outer edge (which becomes the margin side) is closed with new triangles - typically gaps between teeth or in the palate.
Loose pieces removed	Islands smaller than 5% of the scan - cheek, tongue, cotton roll and stray captures - are deleted.
Broken triangles	Edges shared by more than two triangles (non-manifold geometry) are removed so the model can be closed.
mm below the occlusal plane	How deep the scan reaches below the occlusal plane. This limits how much gum can be kept and how tall a base that *follows the scan* can be.

Each arch is also set in a standard frame: teeth up, occlusal plane level, midline front to back, so the models come out level on the build plate. **Restore original upper** and **Restore original lower** (step 2) put a scan back exactly as it was imported, still in the locked bite.

5 The bite: kept as the scanner exported it

Scanners export the upper and lower arches already in occlusion, in the jaw relationship their own software set from the buccal bite record. Pare 3D keeps that bite exactly, as Medit's and 3Shape's model builders do.



The upper and lower arch scans in the scanner's bite (the bite scan itself is hidden).

Why not fit it again

Up to build 77, Pare 3D fitted both arches to the bite scan again. On our three test sets that moved the lower arch by 0.21 to 0.66 mm from where the scanner had put it - more than the published error of scanners' own bite records (about 50-135 µm on bilateral records in vitro [7-9]) - with no evidence that our placement was the better one. From build 78 the scanner's bite is the default; your scanner's software is the reference, as it is for every other model builder.

What the panel says

- *Bite kept exactly as your scanner exported it (the bite scan agrees within ... mm)* - with a bite scan, how far its surface stands from the arches as exported (root-mean-square, points facing the same way within 0.5 mm).
- When that is more than **0.2 mm**, the line turns amber: the bite scan and the scanner's placement disagree. Look at the occlusion from the front and both sides; if it is wrong, use **Line up on the bite scan**.

Line up on the bite scan (when you ask)

Each arch is fitted to the bite scan separately, by **point-to-plane iterative closest point** (ICP) registration, starting from where the scanner left it: about 8,000 points sampled over the arch, each paired with the

nearest bite-scan point only if both surfaces face the same way (normals within about 53°, so an upper cusp never pairs with the lower cusp it touches), the rigid movement that best closes the distances solved and applied, up to 50 times, with the pairing distance narrowing from 2 to 1 to 0.5 mm. The fit is used only when both arches reach below **0.35 mm** RMS over enough shared surface; the panel then shows the residual.

Without a bite scan

- If the two arches touch where the scanner put them, Pare 3D treats them as in occlusion (*Upper and lower are in occlusion*).
- If they do not touch, the models are still made, but the bases are not matched to a bite: *The arches do not touch: add the bite scan to put them in occlusion*.
- If the two scans clearly do not share the scanner's coordinates (one was moved or turned in another program), each is made on its own, side by side, without an articulator.

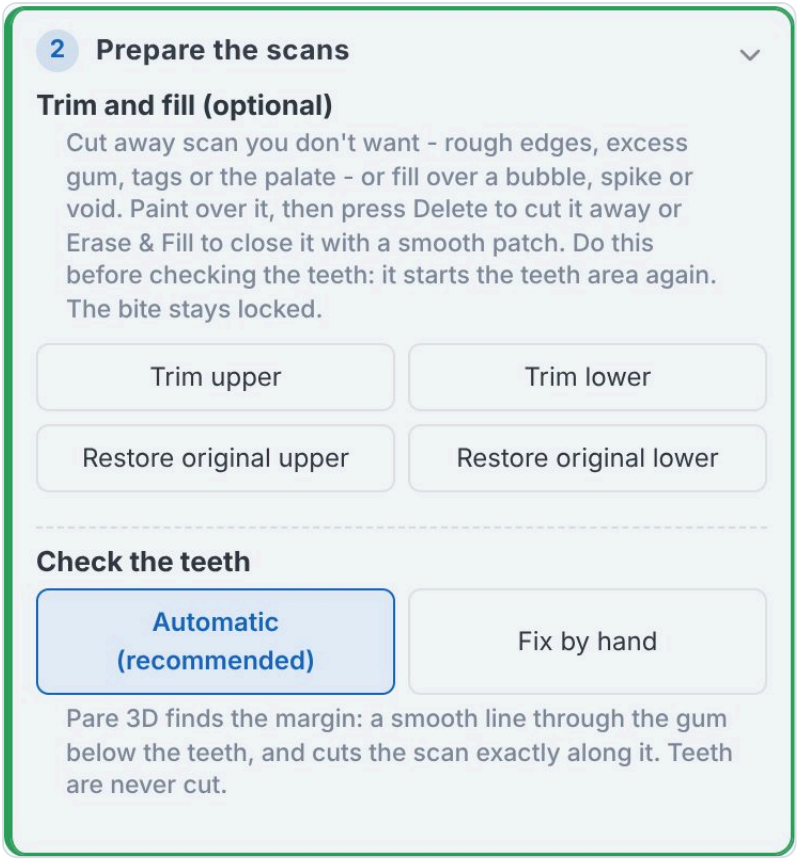
> **Checking the bite yourself**
> Turn the view with the right mouse button (or two fingers on a trackpad) and look from the front and both sides before pressing Make models. The models are made in exactly the relation you see.

Kept through every edit

Each scan's frame - where it stands in the scanner's coordinates - is kept with it through moves, turns, trims, sculpting and cutting the palate away, together with each scan's original file. The models and the articulator are always made in the bite as exported (or as fitted, if you asked). **Restore original upper** and **Restore original lower** put a scan back as it was imported, still in the bite.

6 Step 2 - Prepare the scans: trim and fill, then check the teeth

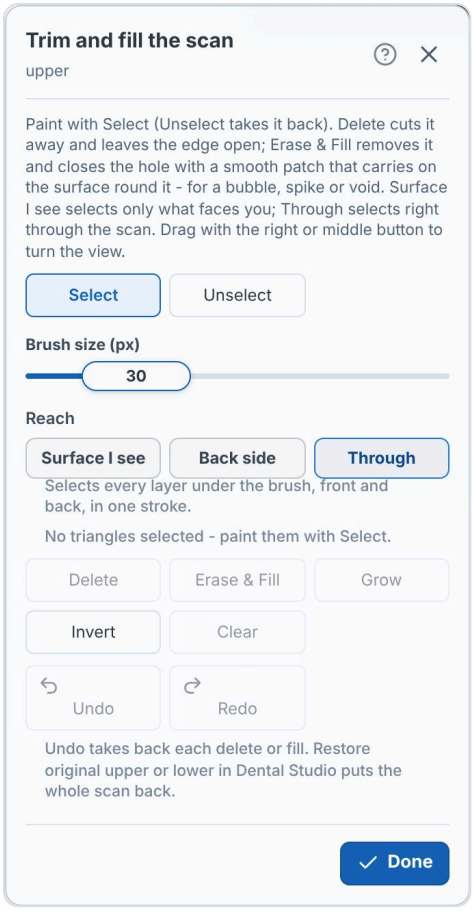
First cut away scan you do not want, or close over a defect; then check what Pare 3D keeps as teeth. In that order: trimming makes the scan anew, so the teeth area is found again after it.



Step 2: Trim and fill (optional) above, Check the teeth below.

Trim and fill (optional)

Trim upper or **Trim lower** opens **Trim and fill the scan** on that arch, with only what this needs. The other scan steps aside while you trim, and the panel stands on the left of the work area, clear of Dental Studio.



Trim and fill: select, then delete or fill; undo and redo.

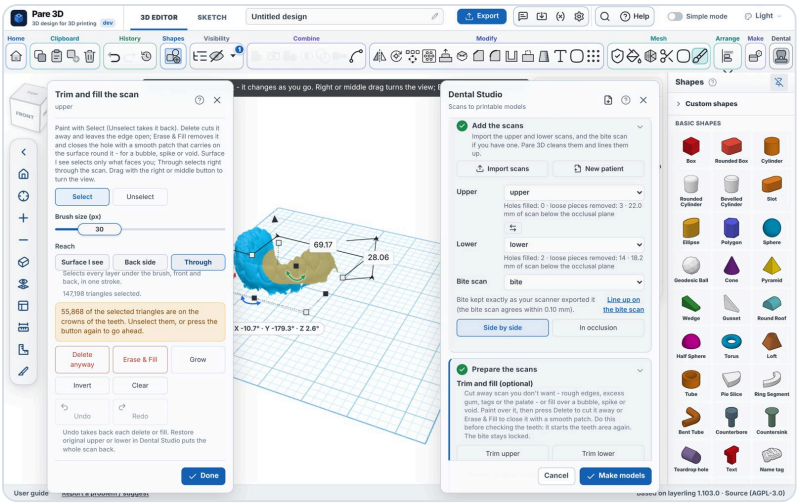
Control	What it does
Select / **Unselect**	Paint over what to cut away; Unselect takes it back.
Brush size	In screen pixels.
Surface I see	Selects only what faces you - nothing hidden behind it.
Back side	The side facing away from you, at any depth.
Through (the default in Trim)	Every layer under the brush - the quick way to take a palate, with no hidden layer left behind.
Delete	Cuts the selection away and leaves the scan's edge open there.
Erase & Fill	Removes the selection and closes the hole with a smooth patch that carries on the surface round it (Liepa's hole filling, faired as a thin-plate surface[5,6], as Meshmixer does). For a bubble, spike or void. A hole that reaches the scan's own edge is left open.
Undo / **Redo**	Take back each delete or fill made since the panel opened, and do it again (`Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Y` too). They never go back past the panel's opening.
Grow, **Invert**, **Clear**	Widen the selection by a ring of triangles, swap selected and not, or start again.

Delete for rough or ragged edges, excess gum, a tag of cheek or tongue, or the palate when the model should be a horseshoe. Erase & Fill for a small defect on the gum or base: a bubble of saliva, a spike, a void where the scanner missed. Keep fills small - a few millimetres; over a large area the patch follows the curve of its rim and can bulge.

After each cut, anything a slicer would call non-manifold - an edge three triangles share, a corner where the scan only touches itself, a loose speck - is tidied away; the scan stays open.

The crowns are guarded

If what you selected takes in the crowns of the teeth, **Delete** and **Erase & Fill** say how many of the selected triangles lie on them and change nothing. Unselect them, or press the button again (**Delete anyway**) to go ahead. A crown is counted from the cusp tips 4 mm outwards and 6 mm down. Anatomical crowns are about 7.5 mm (molars) to 10-11 mm (incisors and canines) from cusp tip or incisal edge to the cemento-enamel junction, so this stays on the crown; on a short clinical crown it can reach the gingival margin. The gum, the palate and flaps of tissue do not count, nor fewer than 25 triangles at the edge of a stroke. A tall tag of tissue standing right behind the last molar can still be taken for a tooth.



A stroke drawn across the crowns: 34,568 of the 64,596 selected triangles lie on them, and nothing was cut.

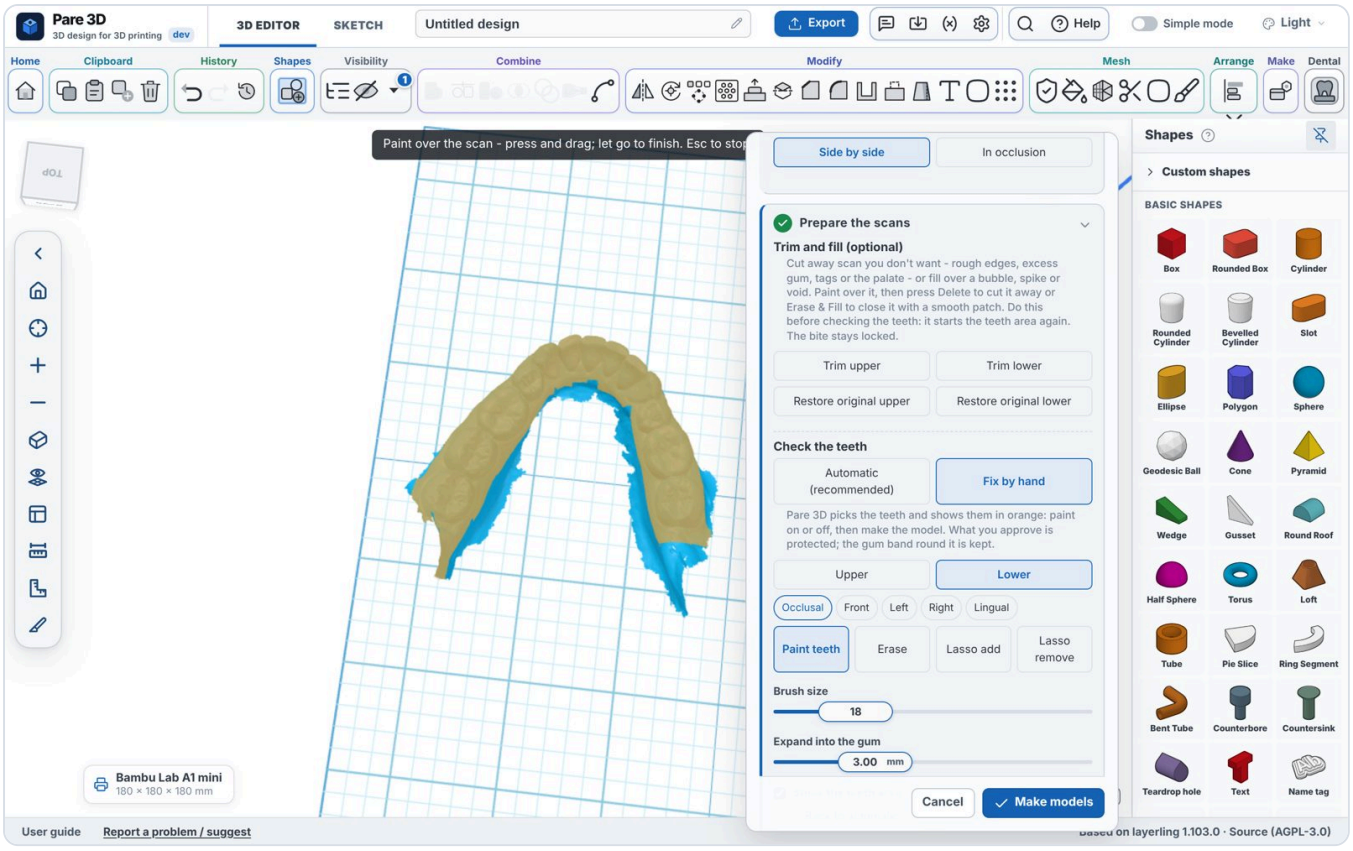
- **The bite stays locked** through every trim (chapter 5).
- **Undo** puts back what was cut or filled; **Restore original upper** / **lower** puts the whole scan back as it was imported.

Check the teeth - Automatic (recommended)

Pare 3D finds the teeth, then lays a smooth line through the gum below them and cuts the scan exactly along it. Teeth are never cut. How far into the gum the line runs is set in step 4 (**Gum below the teeth**).

Check the teeth - Fix by hand

Choose **Fix by hand** when the automatic choice missed a tooth surface (a deep gingival recession, a bridge pontic, an implant scan body) or took tissue for tooth (a frenum, a rugae fold). Pare 3D shows its choice as an **orange** tint on the scan.



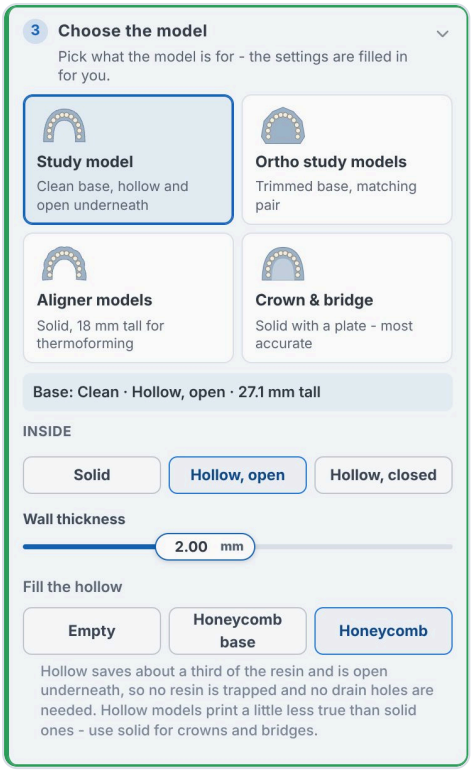
Fix by hand on the lower, from the occlusal side: orange is what the model keeps as teeth.

Control	What it does
Upper / Lower	Which arch you are working on.
Occlusal, Front, Left, Right, Lingual	Turn the view to that side of the chosen arch.
Paint teeth / Erase	Brush the orange area on or off: drag over the surface.
Lasso add / Lasso remove	Draw a closed line round an area to add or remove it in one go.
Expand into the gum	The band of gum kept round the orange area (0.5-10 mm, default 3 mm). The scan is cut smoothly along its outer edge.
Show the teeth area	Hides the orange tint while you look at the scan; it is never shown while a scan is trimmed.
Back to automatic	Discards your changes on this arch.
Sculpt this scan	Opens Sculpt on this arch (chapter 12).

The brushes change only the surface facing you. Turn the view between strokes with the right or middle mouse button; `Esc` puts the brush down. What you mark as tooth is **protected**: the cut never enters it.

7 Step 3 - Choose the model

Pick what the model is for; the base (step 4) and the inside are filled in for that purpose. You can change any of them afterwards.



Each choice shows its base from above; solid or hollow is chosen here too.

Purpose	Base	Inside	Height
Study model	Clean: trimmed to a smooth outline a few mm round the teeth, on a low block	Hollow, open underneath	All anatomy kept, 3 mm base
Ortho study models	Orthodontic: trimmed the British/ABO way; a pair shares one back line	Solid	Base about a third of the model (6-15 mm)
Aligner models	Follows the scan	Solid	About 18 mm overall, for thermoforming
Crown & bridge	With a plate across the arch	Solid	5 mm base

Change the base in step 4 and the choice is marked *custom*; pick the model again to go back to its settings.

Why these defaults

- **Study models** are hollow to save resin: about a third less. They are open underneath, so no resin is trapped and no drain holes are needed.
- **Aligner models** are solid and 15-20 mm tall, as Formlabs recommends for thermoforming: solid models reduce breakage in post-processing, and the height makes the formed appliance easier to remove [1].
- **Crown & bridge** models are solid with a plate across the arch. Hollow models are less true than solid ones, and in hollow models a thicker shell with a cross-arch bar gave the highest accuracy and stability after articulator mounting [2, 3]; solid with a plate is the safest choice where margins and contacts matter.
- **Ortho study models** follow the conventional British/ABO trimming: back square to the midline, heels, buccal sides at 65° (upper) and 55° (lower), the upper's front pointed and the lower's rounded, so the pair stands on its backs in occlusion.

Inside

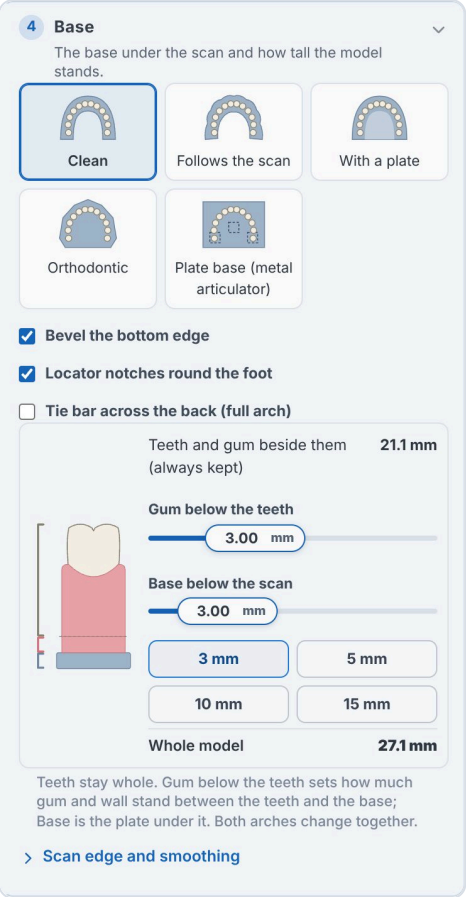
Choice	What it is
Solid	Filled throughout. Prints truest.
Hollow, open	A shell open underneath: about a third less resin, nothing trapped, no drain holes needed.

Hollow, closed	A shell with a closed floor and vent holes up into the hollow, so resin drains and air gets in. Needed for a label underneath.

- **Wall thickness** - 1-5 mm (default 2 mm). Formlabs advises at least 3 mm where a hollow model is thermoformed [1]; thicker shells were more accurate after mounting [2]. The wall is never thinner than set, also round the locator notches.
- **Fill the hollow** - *Empty* saves the most material; *Honeycomb base* stiffens the bottom only; *Honeycomb* carries the whole shell. All drain.

8 Step 4 - The base and the model's height

Always open: the base's shape and details, and how tall the model stands.



Base styles, details and the height.

Style	Shape	Best for
Clean	The scan trimmed to a smooth outline a few mm round the teeth, standing on a low block	Study and patient-education models
Follows the scan	The base wall follows the scan's own edge straight down	Aligners and retainers
With a plate	A plate across the whole arch, palate or tongue space included	Crown and bridge, mounting - stiffest
Orthodontic	Trimmed art base (chapter 7)	Ortho records
Articulator plate	A solid base with pockets underneath for a magnetic articulator plate	Mounting on a physical articulator; always solid

- **Bevel the bottom edge** - a 0.8 mm bevel round the foot, so a scraper gets under it and the model comes off the build plate without chipping.
- **Locator notches round the foot** - half-round notches front and sides, so a lab can seat the model the same way each time. A hollow model keeps its full wall round them.
- **Tie bar across the back (full arch)** - joins the two back ends at the floor so a full arch cannot spread or warp while it prints. Cut it off afterwards.

How tall the model is



A section through a molar in its gum on the base, each part bracketed to scale.

- **Teeth and gum beside them** - always kept: the crowns and the gum right beside them, down to where the deepest tooth reaches.
- **Gum below the teeth** - how much more gum and wall stand between the teeth and the base.
- **Base below the scan** - the block or plate under it, with 3, 5, 10 and 15 mm one click away.
- **Whole model** - the three together, from the floor to the tallest tooth. Both arches change together, and a pair stands equally tall.

The height is measured from the teeth, not from the tallest scrap of scan: on the author's set it reads 26.7 mm and the models came out 25.0 and 26.0 mm tall (before build 75 it read 34 mm).

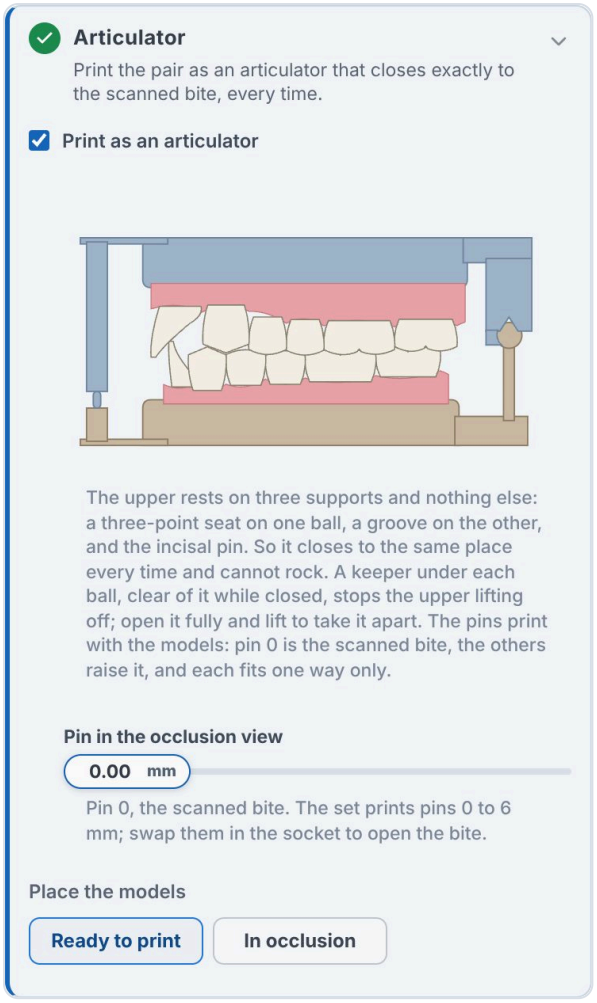
> **Wall too tall?**
> Lower **Gum below the teeth** first, then the base.

Scan edge and smoothing

- **Follow the gum line (palate and floor of the mouth go)** - a band of gum all round the teeth and nothing more, so the model is a horseshoe; its depth is then the *Gum below the teeth* slider.
- **Smooth the scan's edge** - *Off*, *Low* (default) or *High*: how much the ragged scan border is smoothed where it meets the base. The teeth are never smoothed.

9 Step 5 - The articulator

For a pair only. Tick **Print as an articulator** and the two bases print as an articulator built so it cannot change the scanned bite: no joint types, fits or angles to choose.



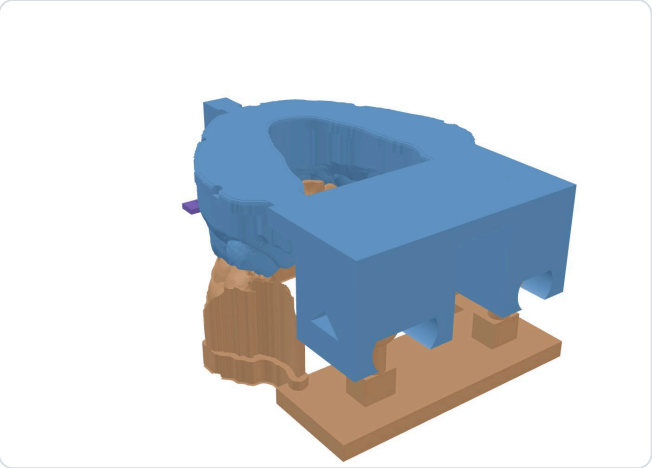
The articulator card: the side view, the pin for the occlusion view, and how the models are placed.

How it holds the bite

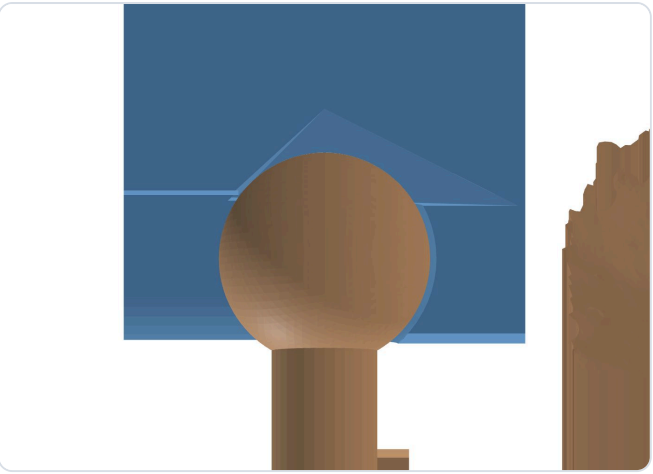
The upper rests on **three supports and nothing else** - a kinematic coupling, the principle precision instruments use to come back to exactly the same position every time [10]. A rigid body has six degrees of freedom; six point contacts fix all six, no more:

- Behind each heel of the lower, a 10 mm **ball condyle**, set as far apart as the models allow.
- Over one ball, a seat in the upper with **three flat faces** (three points); over the other, a **groove** along the hinge axis (two points). The groove lets that ball slide along it, so the distance between the balls never has to match the seats exactly, whatever the printer shrinks.
- In front of the incisors, the **incisal pin**: its rounded tip on a flat pad under the upper - the sixth point.

Nothing else touches - no snap fit, axle or clip to fight the seats - so the models close to the same position every time and cannot rock. The faces slope at 45°, so the upper's own weight slides it home whatever the friction of the resin.



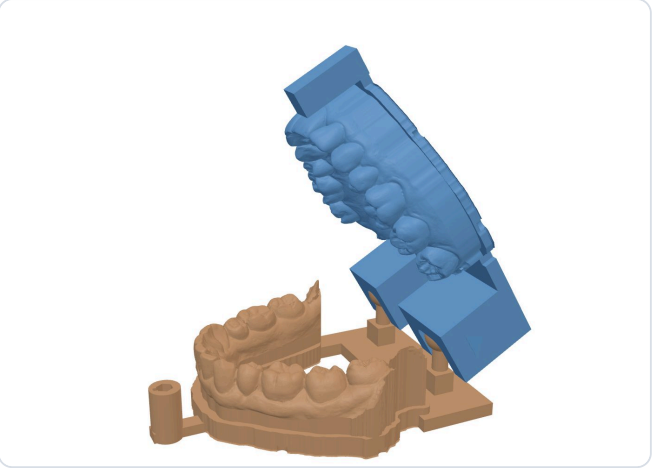
Closed on pin 0: the scanned bite.



A section through a condyle: the seat faces touch the ball above its equator; the keeper below never touches it.



The upper from below: the groove (two points) and the three-faced seat (three points), with the keepers' lips and channels.

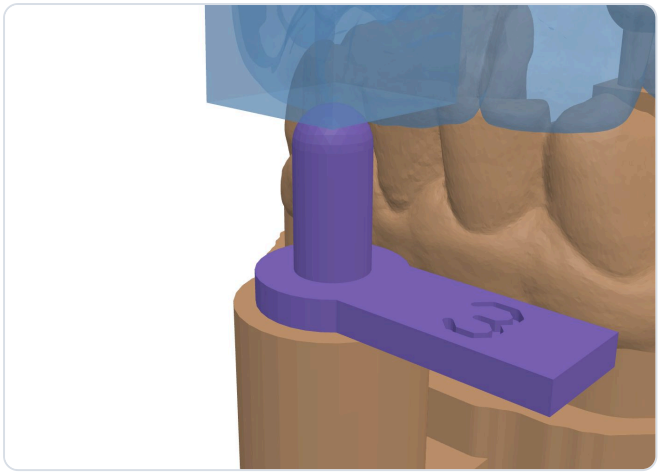


It opens about the line through the two balls, to 90°.

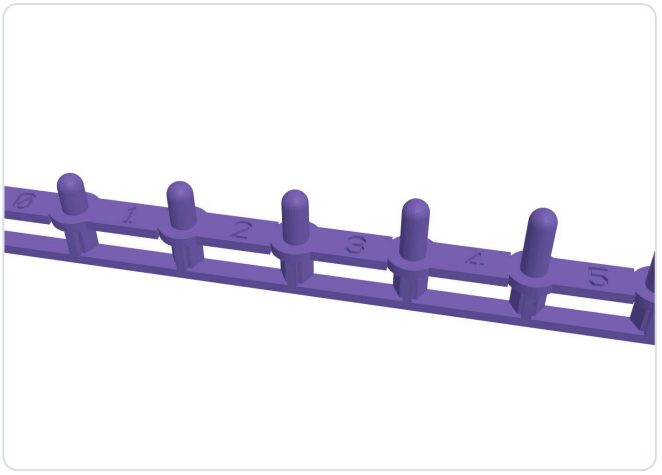
No bands or clips

A **keeper** under each ball - a lip below its equator, 0.3 mm clear of it - never touches while the models are closed, so it cannot change the bite; it only stops the upper lifting off when the models are picked up or turned over (it can rise about 0.4 mm before the keeper catches it). **To take it apart**, open it fully and lift the upper off the balls. **To put it together**, hold the upper open, lower it onto the balls and close it.

The incisal pins



A pin seated on its shoulder in the keyed socket; its tip on the pad. The key means it goes in one way only, its tab to the side.



The pin set, 0 to 6 mm, engraved, on a snap-off bar; it prints with the models.

Pin **0** is the scanned bite. To open the bite - to plan a higher occlusal vertical dimension for a splint or a rehabilitation - swap in a longer pin. As on an articulator the figure is read at the pin, and the bite opens by **turning about the condyles**: the front teeth part by a little less than the pin and the back teeth by less again. After making, the notice says exactly how far for the set, e.g. *pin 3 parts the front teeth 2.7 mm and the back teeth 1.2 mm*.

Setting	Values	What it does
Pin in the occlusion view	0 (scanned bite) to 10 mm, 0.5 mm steps	Which pin the models stand on in the occlusion view; a pin not in the set is added to it. Above 6 mm the panel warns that the arc is unvalidated.
Place the models	Ready to print, In occlusion	Side by side, flat on the build plate with the pins in front; or stacked in the bite, standing on the chosen pin.

Above 6 mm

The condyles stand on an average hinge axis, not the patient's. In a pilot study of 14 patients, average-value virtual mounting matched the patient's posterior opening at 3 and 6 mm increases at the incisors but not at 9 mm [11]. Confirm the vertical dimension clinically.

A quadrant against a full arch

The pair is levelled and laid out by the full arch and articulated as a full pair: a condyle behind each side of the full arch, the incisal pin in front of its central incisors. The quadrant's base grows into a horseshoe 8 mm wide that follows the full arch's base (tongue space left open) and carries both condyles and the pin's socket, so the models cannot rock or flex on the side with no opposing teeth.

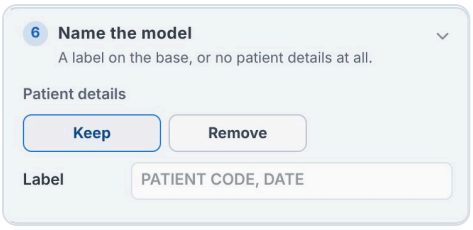
What it does not do

It is a hinge: no protrusive or lateral excursions, no condylar guidance and no facebow transfer. Static virtual articulation - the scanner's bite record, which this articulator reproduces - describes the closed position only; evaluation methods vary and there is no agreed accuracy threshold [12]. For gnathological work - a full-mouth rehabilitation, say - mount the models on an adjustable articulator with a facebow; **Plate base (metal articulator)** in step 4 makes a base for its magnetic plate.

After making, the notice says how far the articulator opens, e.g. *The articulator opens to 90° or more*; under 30° before the models meet, Pare 3D warns you to check it.

10 Step 6 - Name the model

A label on the base, or no patient details at all.



Patient details and the label.

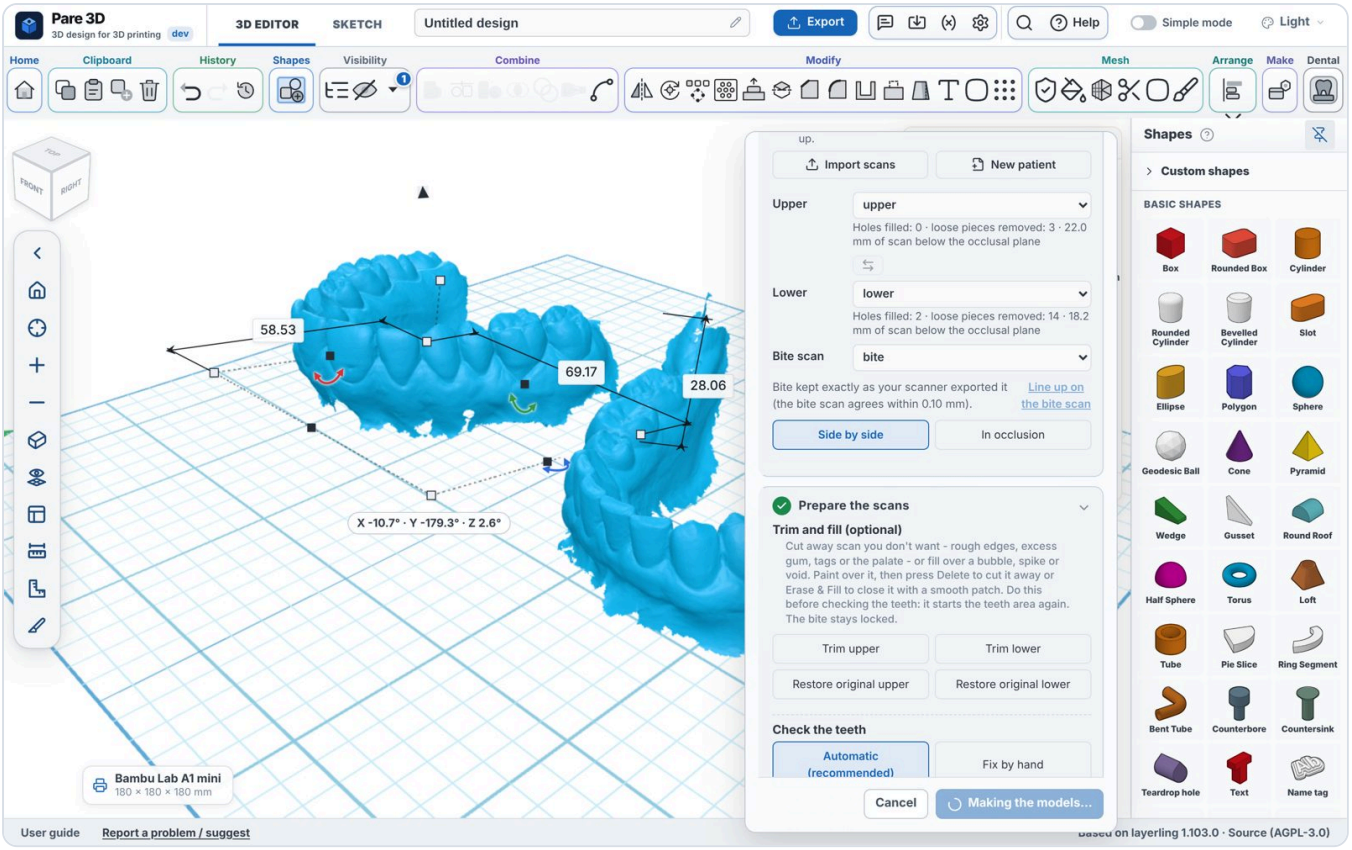
- **Patient details: Keep** names the models after the scan files (often the patient's name) and engraves the label.
- **Patient details: Remove** names them *Upper model* and *Lower model*, renames the bite scan and engraves no label, so the models and every file you export carry nothing that identifies the patient. Pare 3D remembers the choice.
- **Label** - a patient code or a date, engraved on the front of the orthodontic and articulator bases (with U or L in front for a pair) or under the floor on the others. A hollow model open underneath has nowhere to carry it, so with a label its floor is closed, with vent holes.

One patient per design

Keep each patient's scans in a design of their own: **New patient** in step 1 starts one with Dental Studio open. Give the design a case number rather than a name.

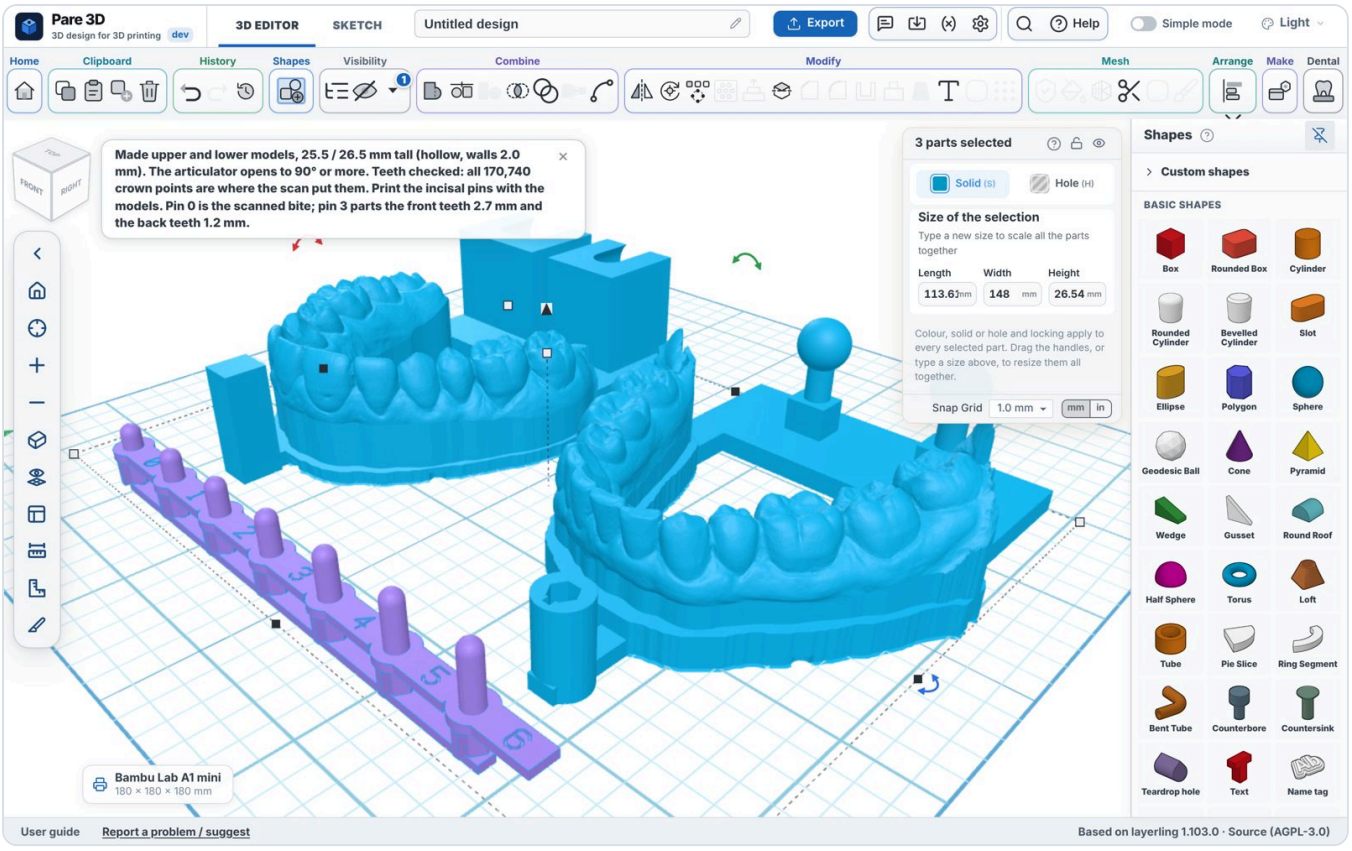
11 Making the models

Press **Make models** (or **Make model** for one arch). The button stays at the bottom of the panel, always on screen.



While the models are made you can still turn the view.

The two arches are made at the same time in two background workers. Then the bases are matched, the articulator parts added, and the models placed. The panel closes; the new models are selected and the scans they came from are replaced (the bite scan is hidden, not deleted). Before a model is handed over it is checked against its scan and written as one clean closed solid; flecks under 5 mm³, sealed bubbles and small tags of scan standing free of the model are left out. Where the gum cut passes within a fifth of an edge of a corner, the corner is moved onto the line rather than a sliver split off, so the margin is made of well-shaped triangles.



The finished pair, ready to print: hollow study bases, snap-in ball articulator, incisal pin and table.

- **Undo** (`Ctrl` / `Cmd` + `Z`) brings the scans back exactly as they were; change a setting and make the models again.
- To change a finished model, select its scan again: Dental Studio works from scans, not from finished models.
- The size of the selection is shown in the side panel; typing a size there scales the models - do not, if they must stay true to the patient.

12 Editing a scan by hand: Sculpt

Sculpt reshapes areas of a scan before the models are made - a spike, a fold of cheek, a rough area. To cut scan away, Trim (chapter 6) is simpler.

Open it from **Sculpt this scan** in Fix by hand, the brush button in the **Mesh** toolbar group, or the right-click menu. The panel opens at once and says *Getting the mesh ready to sculpt…* while a large scan is prepared (about a second for a full arch).

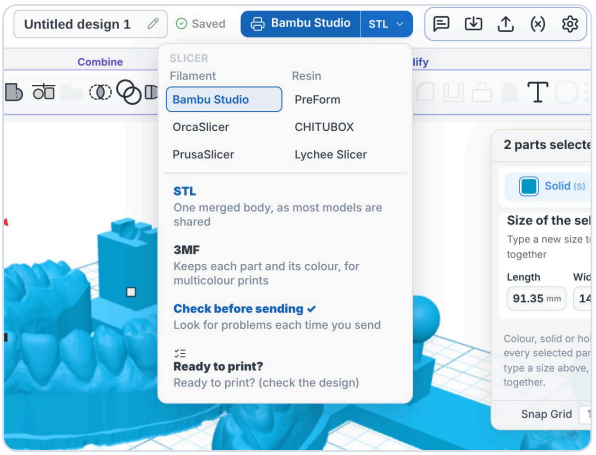
Brush	Effect
Draw, Inflate, Deflate	Raise the surface, or push it out or in along its normals.
Smooth	Evens out bumps and spikes up to the brush's size; at full strength removes fissure detail.
Flatten, Pinch, Crease	Pull the surface onto a plane, together, or into a sharp line.
Move	Drag a patch of surface with the brush.
Select / Unselect	Paint triangles to delete, erase and fill, smooth or flatten as a group.

- **Refine** adds triangles where the brush works, so fine detail can be shaped on a coarse part; **Symmetry** mirrors strokes left-right or front-back.
- Strokes show at once on the full-detail scan. **Undo** and **Redo** (or `Ctrl` / `Cmd` + `Z` and `Y`) step through strokes one at a time, then the deletes and fills made since the panel opened; the scan is rebuilt once when you press **Done**.
- Sculpting one of the Studio's scans hides the other until Sculpt closes; the bite stays locked.

> **Never sculpt the teeth you need to be true**
> Sculpt is for artefacts and soft tissue. Smoothing or flattening a tooth changes the anatomy the model reproduces.

13 Printing

Send the models straight to your slicer from the title bar.



The send menu: slicer and file type.

1. Open the small menu beside the Send button and choose the slicer: **Bambu Studio, OrcaSlicer, PrusaSlicer** (filament) or **PreForm, CHITUBOX, Lychee Slicer** (resin). A slicer not found on this computer is marked *not found*.
2. Choose **STL** (one merged body) or **3MF** (each part separately; the resin slicers read 3MF too).
3. Click **Send to ...**. The app saves a copy in *Documents › Pare 3D Exports* and opens it in the slicer.

With **Check before sending** on, *Ready to print?* first looks for floating parts, thin walls, large overhangs and parts past the build plate.

In a web browser the file is downloaded instead; open it in the slicer yourself.

Printing tips

	Resin (SLA / DLP / LCD)	Filament (FDM)
Orientation	Flat on the plate (Ready to print) for hollow open models; resin drains from underneath. Solid models can be printed flat with no supports.	Flat, teeth up.
Hollow	Use hollow open, or hollow closed with vents; never a closed shell without vents.	Solid or a honeycomb is usually faster than shells.
Articulator	Print flat, as laid out. Keep supports off the seat faces and pad under the upper, the top half of each ball, the pins' tips and the socket's top: printed flat these face away from the plate and need none, and a support mark there changes where the models close. Print the pin fit test (Ready-made parts) once for your printer and resin.	Printing the articulator on filament has not been tested.
Removal	Keep Bevel the bottom edge on.	-

14 Messages and what to do

Message	Meaning and what to do
The bite scan did not line up with the arches	One arch fitted the bite worse than 0.35 mm RMS, or they share too little surface. The scanner's positions are used. Check the bite from the front; re-export the bite scan from the same case if it is wrong.
The two scans are not where the scanner put them...	The arches do not share coordinates (one was moved or turned). Each is made on its own, without bite or hinge. Re-import the original exports.
The arches do not touch: add the bite scan...	No bite scan and the arches are apart. Add the bite scan in step 1.
One scan must be the upper and the other the lower	Both slots name the same arch. Use the swap button or the menus.
Part of the scan's ragged edge could not stand on the base...	The scan was cut where its edge is complete. Check that nothing you need was lost; rescan deeper if it was.
Some of the tooth surface could not be kept where the scan's edge folds under the teeth	An undercut or a fold at the edge. Check the model; trim the fold (step 2, Trim) and make it again.
There was no room for vent holes	A hollow closed model too small for vents. Use hollow open or solid.
The label was left off...	Labels need the orthodontic base, or a plate with a solid or closed inside, and room for letters at least 1.5 mm tall.
Bite kept as your scanner exported it, but the bite scan stands ... mm from it	The bite scan and the scanner's placement disagree by more than 0.2 mm. Check the occlusion from the front and sides; if it is wrong, use Line up on the bite scan.
Teeth checked: ... % of ... crown points are where the scan put them	A few crown points were on specks of scan too small to print at a torn edge, or moved. The notice says how many; check that area of the model before you rely on it.
Teeth of one arch meet the other's gum in the bite (... mm²)	For example lower incisors on the palate in a deep overbite. Left untouched, so the printed models show the contact. Nothing to do; note it for the treatment plan.
Soft tissue cut back clear of the other model: ... mm²	Retromolar or tuberosity tissue that would have met the other model's soft tissue was trimmed 0.5 mm, as a technician trims a cast's heels.
The articulator opens less than 30° before the models meet	Something blocks the opening (tall distal tissue, a tie bar). Check it from the side before printing.
Part of a model came out loose from its base (a piece of the hinge or the stop)	With the articulator on: a piece of the hinge or the stop is not joined. Do not print; report it with the scans (Report a problem in the footer).
Part of a model came out loose from it - a piece of scan standing free of the model	Without an articulator: a piece of scan too big to be a mere tag stands free. Trim the scan there (step 2) and make the model again.

A small tag of scan standing free beside a model was left out	A sliver of cheek or tongue at the end of an arch, walled down to the floor on its own (under 150 mm³ and a twentieth of the model), held no teeth and was left out. Nothing to do.
… of the selected triangles are on the crowns of the teeth	Trim stopped before cutting or filling over crowns. Unselect them, or press the button again to go ahead.
Erased … triangles and filled … hole(s); … opening(s) ran into the scan's edge and were left open	Erase & Fill closed what it could; a hole that reaches the scan's own edge has nothing to close against. Use Delete there instead.
A large mesh - It has … triangles; cutting, grouping and merging handle …	The scan is over the triangle limit for cutting and grouping. Raise it (chapter 3); Dental Studio works either way.
The scans changed while the models were being made	A scan was edited during making. Make the models again.

15 Quick reference

The fastest route

1. Home › Dental models from scans
2. Drag the three scan files onto the window
3. Check: *Bite kept exactly as your scanner exported it*
4. Trim or fill if needed (step 2)
5. Pick the purpose
6. Tick Print as an articulator (pairs)
7. Make models
8. Send to your slicer

Defaults by purpose

	Base	Inside
Study	Clean, 3 mm	Hollow, open
Ortho	Orthodontic	Solid
Aligner	Follows scan, ~18 mm	Solid
C&B	Plate, 5 mm	Solid

The six steps

1 Add the scans · 2 Prepare (trim and fill, then teeth) · 3 Choose the model (and inside) · 4 Base and height · 5 Articulator (pairs) · 6 Name the model. Click a title to fold it.

Bite

Kept as the scanner exported it; amber when the bite scan is more than 0.2 mm off. On request: point-to-plane ICP per arch, normals must agree, 2 → 1 → 0.5 mm, up to 50 rounds, accepted below 0.35 mm RMS, then locked in.

Articulator

Kinematic: two ball condyles (three-faced seat, groove) and the incisal pin; keepers, no bands. Opens 90°. Pins 0-6 mm printed with the models, keyed; occlusion view 0-10 mm in 0.5 mm steps, warning above 6 mm. Socket fit 0.10 mm, or from the pin fit test.

Keys

`Ctrl` + `K` search · `Ctrl` + `Z` undo (in Trim and Sculpt: back to the panel's opening) · `Esc` put a brush down · right or middle drag: turn the view · wheel: zoom.

16 Accuracy, and checking a printed articulator

Accuracy

The Model Builder does not change the scanned tooth surfaces. Bases, hinges, pins and plates are added around the scan, and the teeth are carried through as the scanner recorded them. The accuracy of a finished model therefore depends mainly on:

- **The intraoral scan.** Trueness and precision are set by the scanner, the scanning technique and the clinical conditions. Refer to your scanner manufacturer's specifications.
- **The bite record.** By default, the Model Builder keeps the jaw relationship exactly as your scanning software exported it. Use **Line up on the bite scan** only when the arches arrive unaligned or the exported bite is clearly wrong. It fits each arch to the buccal bite scan and reports the fit residual, so check the occlusion before printing. Published studies show digital bite records are generally more accurate than conventional silicone or wax records [9]. Accuracy falls with fewer teeth, quadrant records, large edentulous spans and scans taken away from the bite record site [13].
- **The printer, resin and post-processing.** Dimensional accuracy depends on the printer's calibration, layer height, resin, orientation, washing and curing. Follow the resin manufacturer's validated settings.
- **The articulator.** Hinge models reproduce the closed intercuspal position only. They do not record or reproduce jaw movements, condylar guidance or a facebow transfer.

Before you use a printed model for any restoration, appliance or diagnosis, check the result. Compare the on-screen occlusion with the patient's scans, confirm the printed teeth seat correctly against each other, and verify critical fits clinically. Pare 3D is a model-building tool, not a medical device. The clinician remains responsible for confirming that a model is fit for its intended use.

What Pare 3D checks for you

- **The teeth.** Every crown point of each scan is checked against the finished model before it is handed over. On the author's scans and six cut-down versions of them, every one of 26,000 to 93,000 crown points per arch was within 0.002 mm of where the scan put it (the limit of the 32-bit numbers the file holds).
- **Soft tissue in the way.** Soft tissue behind the last teeth - the retromolar pad and the tuberosity - that would meet the other model's soft tissue in the bite is cut back 0.5 mm, as a technician trims a cast's heels; otherwise it, not the teeth, would hold the models open. Gum that the other arch's teeth meet, such as the palate under a deep overbite, is never trimmed: that contact tells you how far the bite can be opened. The orthodontic records preset keeps the scans exactly as captured, since any alteration of tooth or soft tissue anatomy invalidates board records [14].
- **Where the scans overlap.** Where the scanner's own bite has teeth overlapping slightly (registration error in the bite record), the printed teeth touch there first, as stone casts from the same records would. On a fixed hinge axis this cannot make the models rock; it can only stop them closing a fraction early.

Checking a printed articulator

No manufacturer publishes how accurately its printed articulator closes, and there is no ISO standard for printed models or articulators. In the one study that measured articulated printed casts, casts on CAD-designed articulation pins were about 333 µm RMS out between the arches, against about 149 µm when articulated by hand [15]. To know for your own printer and resin, this is the protocol Pare 3D is being validated with (in vitro, on a typodont or a patient's casts with consent):

1. **Reference.** Scan a set of arches with a bilateral buccal bite as usual. Mark the canine cusp tips and the first molars' mesiobuccal cusp tips on the scans.

2. **Print.** Make the articulated pair, print it flat with your printer and resin's validated settings, wash and cure as directed, and measure within a day.
3. **Repeatability.** Open and close it 20 times; each time measure the gap at the incisal pin and at a molar with a dial indicator or feeler gauges. Target: standard deviation 25 µm or less.
4. **Trueness of the bite.** Scan the closed pair with a lab or intraoral scanner, register each printed arch to its source scan, and compare the distances between the marked points across the arches with those in the scanned bite. Target: 150 µm RMS or less (stretch: 100 µm).
5. **Contacts.** At the contacts the screen shows, 12 µm shimstock should hold; where it shows none, it should pull through.
6. **Pin steps.** With pins 2, 4 and 6, measure the opening at the incisal edges and the first molars. Target: within 0.15 mm of the figures in the notice.
7. **Durability.** Repeat step 3 after 500 open-close cycles, and after 7 and 14 days.

Publish the printer, resin, settings and every measurement with the results, so others can repeat them.

17 References

1. Formlabs. Thermoformed clear aligners and retainers - application guide. *dental.formlabs.com/indications/thermoformed-clear-aligners-retainers/guide* (accessed 26 October 2026). Models 15-20 mm tall; solid models recommended; hollow walls at least 3 mm.
2. Wan Q, Riera C, Tran TT, Fehmer V, Sailer I, Lee JH. Printing accuracy and post-mounting dimensional stability of 3D-printed hollow dental models with varying shell thicknesses and cross-arch bars. *J Dent*. 2026;164:106234. doi:10.1016/j.jdent.2025.106234
3. Yurdakurban E, Topsakal KG, Duran GS, Görgülü S. Evaluating the accuracy between hollow and solid dental aligner models: a comparative study of printing technologies. *Aust Orthod J*. 2024;40(2):51-62. doi:10.2478/aoj-2024-0023
4. Kwon OK, Yang SW, Kim JH. Correlation between sagittal condylar guidance angles obtained using radiographic and protrusive occlusal record methods. *J Adv Prosthodont*. 2017;9(4):302-307. doi:10.4047/jap.2017.9.4.302 (protrusive records: 30.1° ± 6.7° right, 30.2° ± 6.3° left).
5. Liepa P. Filling holes in meshes. In: *Proceedings of the Eurographics/ACM SIGGRAPH Symposium on Geometry Processing*. Aachen: Eurographics Association; 2003:200-206. doi:10.2312/SGP/SGP03/200-206
6. Kobbelt L, Campagna S, Vorsatz J, Seidel HP. Interactive multi-resolution modeling on arbitrary meshes. In: *Proceedings of SIGGRAPH 98*. New York: ACM; 1998:105-114. doi:10.1145/280814.280831
7. Revilla-León M, Gómez-Polo M, Zeitler JM, Barmak AB, Kois JC, Pérez-Barquero JA. Does the available interocclusal space influence the accuracy of the maxillomandibular relationship captured with an intraoral scanner? *J Prosthet Dent*. 2024;132(2):435-440. doi:10.1016/j.prosdent.2022.09.004 (bilateral record, TRIOS 4: trueness 135 µm at maximum intercuspation, 71-73 µm with the pin opened 3-4°).
8. Lee JD, Luu D, Yoon TW, Lee SJ. Accuracy comparison of bilateral versus complete arch interocclusal registration scans for virtual articulation. *J Prosthet Dent*. 2024;132(5):1038-1043. doi:10.1016/j.prosdent.2023.01.028 (bilateral 53 ± 51 µm; complete arch 265 ± 241 µm).
9. Ries JM, Grünler C, Wichmann M, Matta RE. Three-dimensional analysis of the accuracy of conventional and completely digital interocclusal registration methods. *J Prosthet Dent*. 2022;128(5):994-1000. doi:10.1016/j.prosdent.2021.03.005 (intraoral scanner 0.05 ± 0.04 mm; silicone records 0.41-0.44 mm).
10. Slocum AH. Kinematic couplings: a review of design principles and applications. *Int J Mach Tools Manuf*. 2010;50(4):310-327.
11. Lin YC, Scialabba R, Lee JD, Sun J, Lee SJ. Assessment of occlusal vertical dimension change in mechanical and virtual articulation: a pilot study. *Dent J (Basel)*. 2022;10(11):212. doi:10.3390/dj10110212
12. Zheng Y, Zhang T, Liu Y, Pradíes G, Wang X, Ma D, Bai S. Evaluation methods and influencing factors on accuracy for static virtual articulation obtained by intraoral scanners: a critical review of the literature. *J Esthet Restor Dent*. 2025;37(2):378-399. doi:10.1111/jerd.13312
13. Revilla-León M, Alonso Pérez-Barquero J, Zubizarreta-Macho Á, Barmak AB, Att W, Kois JC. Influence of the number of teeth and location of the virtual occlusal record on the accuracy of the maxillo-mandibular relationship obtained by using an intraoral scanner. *J Prosthodont*. 2023;32(3):253-258. doi:10.1111/jopr.13526
14. American Board of Orthodontics. ABO digital model requirements. exam.americanboardortho.com (accessed 27 October 2026): "Alteration of tooth or soft tissue anatomy, in any form using any method, is considered record falsification."
15. Alhinti O, Kudara Y, Pagni S, El Rafie K, Vazouras K, Ferrari M, Chen YW. Accuracy of occlusal relationships in 3D-printed dental casts: a comparative in vitro study. *J Prosthodont*. 2025. doi:10.1111/jopr.70039 (hand articulation 149.4 µm RMS; CAD-generated articulation pins 332.8 µm).

The registration, cleaning and margin methods described in chapters 4-6 are those implemented in Pare 3D build 78 (files *dentalArch*, *dentalModel* and *dentalArticulator* in the source code, AGPL-3.0). Pare 3D is not a medical device; check every model before clinical use.